Potential EU-UK tariff reprieve for automakers

送信者: POLITICO Pro Morning Mobility Europe 受信日時: 2026-11-13 19:17

【要点】

・EUの欧州委員会は、2027年から適用される原産地規則に対応できない自動車メーカーを支援するため、関税回避の2つの潜在的解決策を非公式に提案した。

・第1案は、2026年の規制に従う電池を2027年に製造できるようにし、供給業者宣言により関税なしで輸出を継続することを認めるが、2027年以降の新型車が同じ優遇措置を受けるかどうかは不明である。

・第2案は2年間有効で、メーカーは欧州サプライヤーからの電池を使用する必要があるが、輸出する特定の車両に同じ電池を搭載する必要がなく、別の車両で使用した欧州製電池の宣言を利用して非欧州製電池搭載車の輸出が可能となる。

・ブレグジット後の通商協定では、EV全体の55%、電池パック全体の70%、電池セルの65%がEUまたは英国産でなければ通関できず、不適合車両には10%の関税が課せられる。

・EU自動車業界団体ACEAは、この関税により業界全体が来年だけで15億ユーロの損失を被ると警告している。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By JORDYN DAHL with TOMMASO LECCA and MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — The Commission

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By JORDYN DAHL

with TOMMASO LECCA and MARTINA SAPIO

View in your browser or listen to audio

SNEAK PEEK

— The Commission has proposed two potential solutions for automakers to avoid new duties on vehicles crossing the Channel next year.

— The Brussels and Belgian governments are at loggerheads over an aircraft approach route at Brussels Airport amid concerns it could become permanent.

— Europe’s shipping giants are sounding the alarm on cyber risks as Hapag-Lloyd and Maersk face fresh security breaches.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Mark your calendars: Our weekly mobility calendar landed in your inbox on Thursday. You can also go online to export and plan your week or suggest your own event.

Tips to jdahl@politico.eu , tlecca@politico.eu and msapio@politico.eu . Follow us @tommylecca , @jordyndahl and @martsapio .

DRIVING THE DAY

COMMISSION PUTS FORWARD ONE-YEAR DELAY ON EU-UK CAR TARIFFS: The European Commission has unofficially proposed two potential solutions for automakers facing new duties next year if vehicles fail to meet rules-of-origin requirements when crossing between the U.K. and the EU, two people familiar with the discussions told POLITICO.

Reminder: Under the post-Brexit trade agreement, a vehicle can cross the Channel tariff-free so long as it complies with rules of origin: at least 55% of an EV, 70% of the battery pack and 65% of the battery's cells must come from the EU or the U.K. from 2027 onward. Automakers on both sides of the Channel face a 10% duty on vehicles that don't comply with the rules of origin, starting Jan. 1. EU car lobby ACEA warns the tariffs will cost the sector €1.5 billion next year alone.

Behind door No. 1: Vehicles that cross borders require a supplier declaration that essentially confirms the components comply with rules-of-origin requirements and other trade regulations. The Commission proposal would allow batteries produced next year to follow the 2026 regulations and vehicles would receive a declaration allowing them to still be exported without paying the tariff. The problem for automakers is it's unclear whether new models of vehicles introduced in 2027 would receive the same preferential treatment or not.

Behind door No. 2: The second proposal would be in place for two years and also involves supplier declarations. Automakers would still need to use batteries from European suppliers, but the battery would not have to be in the specific vehicle being exported. An automaker could receive a supplier declaration for a European battery used in one vehicle but use that declaration to export a vehicle with a non-European battery without paying the tariff. The vehicle with the European battery would remain in the EU.

The catch: The ideas have been floated verbally but no written, formal proposal has been offered by the Commission, the two people say. The executive wants to see if the solution is palatable to industry. ACEA and British lobby group SMMT are going to put the proposal to their members — some like BMW and Toyota are in both organizations — to get their feedback, Jonathan O'Riordan, ACEA's trade director, told Jordyn on Thursday.

Technically feasible: The industry received a reprieve from the duties in 2023 when the U.K. and the Commission negotiated a three-year delay to the new rules. But the lawmakers added a lock-in mechanism that makes it "legally impossible " to change the rules again before 2032. The Commission's proposals would not change the rules themselves, instead targeting the customs mechanism.

Politically challenging: The new rules come as the EU institutions negotiate the Industrial Accelerator Act, which will set local content requirements across strategic sectors in clean technology, including EVs and batteries. Critics warn that giving any further extensions to the industry now would undermine the Commission's credibility in enforcing the IAA. The risk is also that automakers could ask for yet another delay when the next deadline comes around.

Across the channel: Commission trade czar Maroš Šefčovič has held discussions with U.K. Trade Secretary Jonathan Reynolds, during which the EU official said the duties are in neither side's interest. The two sides are meeting on Nov. 20 for an EU-U.K. summit, but the car tariffs are not a formal part of

the discussions, a U.K. government official told Jon Stone, adding the issue will be talked about on the sidelines.

AVIATION

BRUSSELS VS BELGIUM OVER AIRPORT FLIGHT PATH: Brussels' regional government and Belgium's federal one became embroiled in a dispute Thursday over who is to blame for the controversial RNP 07L, an approach route used by aircraft landing at Zaventem's Brussels Airport that has shifted aircraft noise from southeastern to northwestern Brussels since 2025. The route, introduced as a temporary solution, could become permanent.

Forgot something? The Brussels regional government, a consistent opponent of the route, appeared to have missed the deadline to challenge a move to make the route permanent, Belgian newspapers De Standaard and Le Soir reported Thursday. Responsibility for the alleged missed deadline was attributed to Elke Van den Brandt, the regional mobility minister, who reportedly failed to forward a notification sent in July by federal Mobility Minister Jean-Luc Crucke to the relevant state secretary. The notification, according to the reports, concerned a proposal to make the route permanent.

Some context: The Brussels regional government has already challenged the controversial flight path in lower courts, arguing that it shifted aircraft noise to a densely populated area that is also among the poorest in the country. However, challenging the latest federal move to make the route permanent could have allowed the regional government to bring the dispute directly before the Council of State, the country's supreme administrative court.

Blame game: The allegedly missed deadline quickly became a source of political recriminations, shifting attention from the federal government's responsibility for the route to a blame game between who in the regional government failed to protect Brussels' residents.

Don't give up: In response to the reports, the Brussels government discussed three legal avenues still available to challenge the flight path — including an appeal to the Council of State filed by a regional body responsible for welfare and health. In addition, the Brussels government said it would examine the legal consequences of allegedly missing the deadline.

Plot twist: The federal mobility minister's office denied that it had attempted to make the northwestern approach route permanent. "Its use is temporary and depends on ongoing studies that need to map out alternatives," said the ministry. The minister's office also said the letter sent in July was not an official decision and therefore should not have triggered any deadline for an appeal.

Don't be fooled: Free Air 4 Brussels, an NGO representing residents of northern Brussels, said Crucke is responsible for the "over 60,000 Brussels residents [that] have their sleep severely disrupted by air traffic," with over 10,000 flights passing over their homes each year. In an emailed statement, the group described the federal government's handling of the flight path as "a permanent decision disguised as a test."

**Know the room before you walk in. Politics is a people business, so we built the new POLITICO app around the people. Look up any lawmaker, staffer or official and see what they're responsible for, where they've been and who they work with, right next to everything we've reported on them. Tap a name in any story, newsletter or podcast and their page opens. It's the fastest way to prep for a meeting, a hearing or a panel, whether that's on Capitol Hill, at the Commission or in Westminster. Get the new app. **

MARITIME

SHIPPING'S CYBER RISK: German shipping giant Hapag-Lloyd has upgraded the potential financial impact of a cyberattack to "critical" in its latest results , underscoring growing concerns about cybersecurity among the world's biggest container shipping companies.

And it's not theoretical: Danish giant Maersk also disclosed Wednesday that hackers had gained unauthorized access to a legacy IT system inherited through an earlier acquisition and extracted data. The company said the breach had been contained and that no sensitive data appeared to have been exposed.

Why Europe should worry: Maritime transport carries roughly 73 percent of the EU's external trade by weight and half by value, making major shipping companies critical to European supply chains. As vessels, ports and terminals become increasingly dependent on interconnected digital systems, a serious cyberattack could disrupt far more than company databases.

A costly precedent: Maersk knows the risks firsthand. The 2017 NotPetya cyberattack crippled its global operations for weeks and cost the company an estimated $300 million. Nearly a decade later, the latest incident — involving an older system inherited through its 2022 acquisition of LF Logistics — highlights the cybersecurity challenges facing an increasingly digital and interconnected shipping industry.

TRUMP SAYS U.S. HAS 'GOT' HORMUZ: U.S. President Donald Trump said Thursday that Washington no longer needs a deal with Iran, saying in a social media post that "We've got their money, Hundreds of Billions of Dollars, and we've got their Strait!"

The timing: Trump's language comes just days after he told media that Qatar and Saudi Arabia would prefer a peaceful solution to the Iran conflict, while Secretary of State Marco Rubio said the U.S. blockade and sanctions were working well enough that major combat operations did not need to resume.

But the water is still dangerous: Commercial traffic through Hormuz is recovering, but so are attacks. October was the busiest month for Gulf LNG exports since the war began, with 31 LNG tankers carrying cargo out of the strait, while the Washington Institute counted 37 vessels hit that same month. The IMO has confirmed 130 incidents since the conflict began, with at least 25 seafarers killed.

Why it matters: More ships are returning because freight rates are high and some Gulf exports are recovering, but that also means more potential targets. Trump's claim that the U.S. has "got" the strait therefore lands against a backdrop where control of Hormuz remains contested and commercial shipping is still operating under heavy security risk.

PIT STOPS

From us : Mercedes-Benz is halting all investments in Germany and considering closing factories in the country, according to an internal memo.

The Commission opened a call for expressions of interest to collect information on testing and deploying cellular-based dual-use drone detection technologies.

Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Burnham to discuss ‘problem’ Chinese imports in final days of Brexit reset talks
The British prime minister said there will be “long nights ahead” as he finalizes a reset deal with Brussels.
By Caroline Hug · Nov 12, 2026, 09:27 pm Europe/Brussels CET

Mercedes halts German investments
By Jordyn Dahl · Nov 12, 2026, 09:14 pm Europe/Brussels CET

EU closes antitrust probe into Dutch rail operator
By Jacob Parry · Nov 12, 2026, 03:04 pm Europe/Brussels CET

EU court rejects Poland’s bid to overturn 7 major climate laws
Lawsuits launched by the previous nationalist government were kept alive under pro-EU Prime Minister Donald Tusk.
By Bartosz Brzeziński · Nov 12, 2026, 12:25 pm Europe/Brussels CET

Weekly Calendar

Here’s a selection of upcoming key events, find the complete Week Ahead online.

IATA ‘159th IATA Slot Conference’
Nov 17, 2026 - Nov 19, 2026 · Budapest, HU

Council Working Party on Land Transport
Nov 17, 2026 · Brussels, BE

R&A Workshop – The EU’s electricity price challenge
Nov 17, 2026, 8:15 AM - 10:00 am

Made with Europe: Advancing Europe’s Digital Sovereignty?
Nov 17, 2026, 11:00 AM - 12:00 pm

Coreper I
Nov 18, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Coreper II
Nov 18, 2026 · Brussels, BE

EASA Annual Safety Conference
Nov 18, 2026, 9:00 AM - Nov 19, 2026, 5:00 PM · Dublin, IE

EU General Affairs Council
Nov 19, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Irish presidency of the Council ‘European Migration Network’ conference
Nov 19, 2026 - Nov 20, 2026 · Dublin, IE

Pro Roundtable – Cyber
Nov 19, 2026, 8:15 AM - 9:45 am

POLITICO Pro Petit-Déjeuner – Défense

Nov 19, 2026, 8:15 AM - 10:00 am

Pro Leaders Club – Public Affairs Forum
Nov 19, 2026, 9:30 AM - 2:00 pm

IATA 'CO2 Data Workshop'
Nov 19, 2026, 10:00 AM · Geneva, CH

CLEPA Innovation Awards Ceremony
Nov 19, 2026, 6:00 PM - 10:00 pm · Brussels, BE
This event will celebrate the breakthrough technologies driving greener and more connected mobility in Europe, bringing together industry leaders, policymakers and media in Brussels to recognize the year's top automotive innovators

Council Working Party on Space
Nov 20, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Eurocontrol Data Protection Supervisory Board
Nov 20, 2026, 10:00 AM - 3:00 pm · Brussels, BE

European Parliament plenary session
Nov 23, 2026 - Nov 26, 2026 · Strasbourg, FR

Pro Intelligence Connections
2026/0068(COD) Acceleration of industrial capacity…
Referral of the legislative proposal to the EP com…
Remarks by Executive Vice-President Maroš Šefčovič…
Dec 6, 2023 • European Commission - Statement

This email alert has been sent for your exclusive use as a POLITICO Pro subscriber. Forwarding or reproducing the newsletter without the express, written permission of POLITICO Pro is a violation of the POLITICO Pro license agreement.

This email was sent to shondo@iies.co.jp
Update settings | Unsubscribe from this email | Unsubscribe from all emails
POLITICO SRL · Rue de la Loi 62 · Brussels 1040 · Belgium